

Creating Safer Communities Through Active Transportation Infrastructure

Recommendation for Congress

Support H.R. 7751, the **Parks to People Active Transportation Act**, to expand access to green space, strengthen local economies, improve public health, and create a national network of safe walking and biking infrastructure that connects communities to parks, jobs, and public transportation.

About the Bill

Globally, the United States is **falling behind in public transportation**. Lack of quality public transportation threatens economic opportunities, human health, education, and rider safety. With urban population on the rise, the transportation sector must create reliable, equitable systems for residents. Greenways are an essential solution for the United States as they build bridges between communities and nature. In turn, greenways support local economies, improve public health, decrease emissions, and increase safety.

The Parks to People Active Transportation Act would establish a grant program through the Department of Transportation (DOT) to create greenways for states, localities, and Native Tribes.

What would the bill do?

1. Establish a national greenway paths network

- a. The Secretary of DOT will establish a national greenway paths network where the paths are regionally or nationally significant. These paths will cross local or state lines, reduce single-vehicle trips, and support community efforts.

2. Create a grant fund to construct greenways for network

- a. Authorizes the Secretary of DOT to appropriate \$300,000,000 each year from 2027 to 2031 for the grant fund. At least \$5,000,000 allocated for design grants and at most \$3,500,000 for administrative costs. The federal grant fund will cover 80% of an eligible project's total cost while 20% must be covered already. Exceptions: 90% covered for rural areas; 100% covered for high poverty areas.

3. Accelerate outdoor infrastructure construction while facilitating educational, economic, and recreational opportunities.

- a. The Secretary will select projects by considering the project's ability to: provide additional opportunities for walking and biking, facilitate access to recreation areas and public transportation, and demonstrate improvement of quality of life, pedestrian safety, and economic benefits.

Why support H.R. 7751?

Greenways work.

Greenways promote biodiversity, preserve nature, and increase access to recreation. Generally, outdoor recreation generates **\$124.5** billion in federal, state, and local tax revenue each year. At the local level, property values tend to **increase** near greenways, small businesses benefit from increased foot traffic, and greenways create more jobs. Outdoor recreation infrastructure also reduces crime, improves educational outcomes, and lowers healthcare costs by encouraging physical and mental **fitness**.

Already implemented at the local level, The High Line in New York City, the Atlanta BeltLine, and the East Coast Greenway all exemplify the proven benefits of greenways. **The High Line is on average 7.2°F cooler than surrounding neighborhoods and improves air quality.** By 2027, it will have generated over \$1.4 billion in tax revenue for New York City, roughly \$65 million annually from 2007.

Americans are ready for greenways.

90% of Americans believe communities must be designed to reduce single-occupancy vehicles and encourage walking. 92% of Americans want more green spaces. Additionally, the bill is endorsed by the Trust for Public Land, Outdoor Alliance, American Trails, League of American Bicyclists, Clean Air Council, and many more local and state organizations.

The United States needs Greenways.

A lack of public transportation weakens the national economy and worker productivity, according to the AFL-CIO. Outdoor infrastructure is a powerful tool where communities, employers, and government all benefit. The U.S. needs greenways to facilitate economic growth, and create safer, healthier communities.

House sponsors: LaMonica McIver (D-NJ-10) and Lucy McBath (D-GA-6)

House cosponsors: Nanette Diaz Barragán (D-CA-44), Troy A. Carter (D-LA-2), Henry C. “Hank” Johnson (D-GA-4), Robert Menendez (D-NJ-8), Eleanor Holmes Norton (D-DC-At Large), Lateefah Simon (D-CA-12), Dina Titus (D-NV-1), Rashida Tlaib (D-MI-12)



Uniting science, wonder,
and action for a sustainable,
just and peaceful future.

The Rachel Carson Council (RCC), founded in 1965, is the national environmental organization envisioned by Rachel Carson to carry on her work after her death. We promote Carson's ecological ethic that combines scientific concern for the environment and human health with a sense of wonder and reverence for all forms of life in order to build a more sustainable, just, and peaceful future. The Rachel Carson Council is a nonpartisan 501(c)(3) nonprofit organization.